



Carlington & Burling LLP

ADMIN · DOCUMENT BUILDER

Playbook

A guide to building official firm documents
with the Carlington & Burling Document Builder.

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Carlington & Burling

LLP · ATTORNEYS AT LAW · SINCE 1919
850 Tenth Street NW, Washington, DC 20001 · 202-662-6000 · carlingtonburling.com

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SECTION I Introduction & Access

This playbook documents the Carlington & Burling LLP Admin Document Builder. It enables authorized firm personnel to generate professional, fillable PDF documents in the official firm template style — centered Cormorant Garamond letterhead with gold accent rules and AcroForm fillable fields for client-facing use.

Accessing the Admin

01 Open the admin portal

Navigate to carlingtonburling.com/admin in a modern browser (Chrome, Safari, or Firefox). The login screen loads in the cream brand background.

02 Authenticate

Enter the admin password at the prompt. Default access key: `covbur1919`. Authentication uses a JWT bearer token stored in `sessionStorage` for the duration of the browser tab.

03 Land on the dashboard

On success, the dashboard shell loads with Document Builder, Requests, Email Templates, and Analytics tabs. Session persists across page reloads in the same tab. Closing the tab clears the token.

04 Rotate the password

The password is set via the `PASSWORD` environment variable in Vercel. To rotate: update `PASSWORD` in the Vercel dashboard under Settings, then Environment Variables, and redeploy.

Interface Overview

The Document Builder uses a two-pane layout. The left sidebar (~380px) holds all document configuration: preset selector, title input, form fields, clauses, and signature blocks. The main area shows a live preview summary plus Generate PDF and Download buttons. A status indicator surfaces the current PDF generation state.

Security Notes

PDF generation runs entirely in the browser. No document body or field data is transmitted to any server. The Express API at `/api/admin` only handles authentication and request-list metadata. For added defense, deploy the admin route behind your firm SSO or VPN — the current password gate is intended as a single layer, not a complete security model.

SECTION II Generating a Document

01 Load a preset or start fresh

Use the Load Preset dropdown at the top of the sidebar to select a starting template (Waiver and Release, Mutual NDA, or Blank). Selecting a preset populates fields, clauses, and signature blocks automatically. Choose Custom to build from scratch.

02 Configure document metadata

Enter the document title (e.g. ENGAGEMENT LETTER), output filename, and optionally customize the witness preamble. The default witness preamble reads: "IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties have executed this Agreement as of the date set forth above."

03 Add form fields

Form fields create fillable blanks in the generated PDF. Each has a label (visible text, e.g. "Client Name:") and a name (internal AcroForm identifier). Click + Add Field to add a row, × to remove. Field width defaults to 370 points and is customizable per field.

04 Compose clauses

Clauses are the substantive provisions. Each has a number, title (e.g. "Governing Law."), and body. Click + Add Clause to add. Body text wraps; if a page overflows, a new page is created automatically with the letterhead reprinted.

05 Configure signature blocks

Up to two signature blocks render side-by-side. Each has a label and a list of fields. The Signature type renders as a signature line with the [SEAL] notation. Add Print Name, Title, or Date fields beneath as needed.

06 Generate the PDF

Click Generate PDF in the toolbar. The browser builds the PDF synchronously via pdf-lib. A green status pill confirms success. The PDF downloads automatically with the filename you set in step two.

07 Distribute the document

Email the PDF to the client or upload to your document management system. Clients can fill the AcroForm fields in Acrobat or Preview, or print and complete by hand.

SECTION III Document Types by Practice Area

The seven core practice areas each have a recommended set of document types. For every type below, you will find required form fields and a suggested clause structure. Use these as starting points when building documents in the admin builder.

OI Antitrust & Competition

Complex merger reviews, civil and criminal cartel investigations, and competition litigation across jurisdictions worldwide.

Engagement Letter — Antitrust

Standard engagement letter for antitrust matters. Includes scope, fee structure, conflict waiver, and lead-partner contact.

Form Fields

- Client Name
- Date
- Matter Description
- Billing Rate
- Lead Partner

Clauses

- Scope of Representation
- Fee and Billing Terms
- Conflict Waiver
- Termination
- Governing Law

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Joint Defense Agreement

For multi-party antitrust investigations. Governs sharing of privileged information among co-defendants. Includes common-interest doctrine language and withdrawal provisions.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Party A
- Party B
- Matter/Case No.
- Lead Counsel

Clauses

- Common Interest Privilege
- Confidentiality of Shared Materials
- No Waiver of Privilege
- Withdrawal Procedure
- Governing Law

Document Preservation Notice

Issued to clients upon receipt of a subpoena or CID. Instructs on preservation obligations for ESI and physical documents. Includes litigation-hold language.

Form Fields

- Date Issued
- Client Name
- Matter/Case No.
- Response Deadline
- Issuing Authority

Clauses

- Preservation Obligations
- Scope of ESI to Preserve
- Consequences of Spoliation
- Point of Contact
- Acknowledgment of Receipt

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

02 Litigation

Bet-the-company trials, appeals, and arbitrations across commercial, securities, and constitutional disputes.

Engagement Letter — Litigation

Comprehensive engagement letter including detailed scope, budget estimate, discovery obligations, and alternative fee arrangements.

Form Fields

- Client Name
- Date
- Case Caption
- Court/Venue
- Fee Arrangement
- Initial Retainer

Clauses

- Scope of Representation
- Fee and Expense Terms
- Client Cooperation
- Discovery Responsibilities
- Settlement Authority
- Withdrawal
- Governing Law

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Settlement Agreement

Full settlement and release for resolved litigation. Includes mutual releases, payment terms, dismissal with prejudice, confidentiality, and non-disparagement.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Plaintiff
- Defendant
- Case No.
- Settlement Amount
- Payment Deadline

Clauses

- Recitals
- Payment Terms
- Mutual Release
- Dismissal with Prejudice
- Confidentiality
- Non-Disparagement
- No Admission of Liability
- Entire Agreement
- Governing Law

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Protective Order Stipulation

Joint stipulation for a protective order governing confidential discovery. Includes tiers of confidentiality, clawback provisions, and procedures for challenging designations.

Form Fields

- Court
- Case No.
- Case Caption
- Date of Stipulation

Clauses

- Definitions
- Designation of Confidential Material
- Attorneys' Eyes Only Tier
- Use of Protected Material
- Clawback Procedure
- Challenging Designations
- Return at Conclusion

03 Intellectual Property

Patent, trademark, copyright, and trade secret litigation, plus strategic counseling and portfolio management.

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

IP Engagement Letter

For IP prosecution or litigation. Specifies the IP asset (patent no., trademark reg., etc.), scope of services, and USPTO or court fees.

Form Fields

- Client Name
- Date
- IP Asset
- Registration/Patent No.
- Fee Arrangement

Clauses

- Scope of IP Services
- USPTO/Court Fees
- Client Cooperation
- File Retention
- Termination
- Governing Law

Confidentiality & IP Assignment

Employee or contractor agreement assigning IP to the company. Includes invention disclosure procedures, moral rights waiver, and power of attorney.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Employee/Contractor
- Company
- State

Clauses

- Definitions of IP
- Assignment of Inventions
- Disclosure Obligations
- Moral Rights Waiver
- Power of Attorney
- Return of Company Property
- Survival
- Governing Law

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Trademark License Agreement

License agreement for trademark use. Specifies quality control, territorial scope, royalty structure, and termination rights.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Licensor
- Licensee
- Mark
- Territory
- Royalty Rate

Clauses

- Grant of License
- Quality Control Standards
- Royalty and Reporting
- Term and Renewal
- Infringement Enforcement
- Indemnification
- Termination
- Governing Law

04 Corporate

M&A, capital markets, governance, and complex commercial transactions for Fortune 500 and emerging enterprises.

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Corporate Engagement Letter

For transactional matters. Includes deal structure overview, fee arrangements (including success fees), and team composition.

Form Fields

- Client Name
- Date
- Transaction
- Fee Structure
- Lead Partner

Clauses

- Scope of Engagement
- Fee and Expense Terms
- Team Composition
- Third-Party Costs
- Conflicts Waiver
- Termination
- Governing Law

M&A Due Diligence Request List

Comprehensive DD request list. Categories: corporate organization, financial, tax, IP, employment, litigation, regulatory.

Form Fields

- Target Company
- Date Issued
- Response Deadline
- Deal Code Name

Clauses

- Corporate Organization & Records
- Financial & Tax
- Intellectual Property
- Employment & Benefits
- Litigation & Regulatory
- Material Contracts
- Environmental
- Insurance

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Board Resolution

Formal board resolution approving a corporate action. Includes recitals, resolutions, and authorization language.

Form Fields

- Company
- Date of Meeting
- Resolution Title
- Members Present

Clauses

- Recitals
- Resolutions
- Authorization
- Certification
- Effective Date

05 White Collar Defense & Investigations

Government investigations, enforcement actions, and criminal proceedings — FCPA, fraud, and sanctions matters.

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Engagement Letter — Investigation

For internal or government-facing investigations. Includes scope, Upjohn warning language (corporate clients), privilege, and interview protocols.

Form Fields

- Client Name
- Date
- Investigation
- Agency
- Fee Arrangement

Clauses

- Scope of Investigation
- Privilege and Upjohn Warning
- Interview Protocols
- Document Collection & Review
- Reporting Obligations
- Joint Defense Considerations
- Fee and Expense Terms
- Governing Law

Proffer Agreement

Governs the terms of a client proffer to government investigators. Includes scope of waiver, derivative use restrictions, and impeachment limitations.

Form Fields

- Date
- Witness Name
- Agency
- Case No.
- AUSA

Clauses

- Scope of Proffer
- Waiver of Rights
- Derivative Use Restrictions
- Impeachment Exception
- No Waiver of Attorney-Client Privilege
- Acknowledgment

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Internal Investigation Report

Template for internal investigation findings. Covers executive summary, methodology, factual findings, legal analysis, and recommendations.

Form Fields

- Date
- Subject Matter
- Prepared By
- Distribution
- Privilege Designation

Clauses

- Executive Summary
- Methodology
- Factual Findings
- Legal Analysis
- Recommendations
- Privilege Log
- Document Retention

06 Health Care

Regulatory, transactional, and litigation counsel to providers, payors, pharma, and medical device manufacturers.

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Health Care Engagement Letter

For health care regulatory, transactional, or litigation matters. Includes HIPAA compliance obligations and FDA regulatory scope.

Form Fields

- Client Name
- Date
- Matter
- Agency
- Fee Arrangement

Clauses

- Scope of Representation
- HIPAA & Data Privacy
- FDA Regulatory Scope
- Fee and Expense Terms
- Conflict Waiver
- Termination
- Governing Law

Business Associate Agreement (BAA)

HIPAA-required BAA. Defines permitted PHI uses, breach notification, and subcontractor requirements.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Covered Entity
- Business Associate
- Services

Clauses

- Definitions
- Permitted Uses of PHI
- Business Associate Obligations
- Breach Notification
- Subcontractors
- Term and Termination
- Governing Law

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Clinical Trial Agreement

Between sponsor and research institution. Includes protocol compliance, IP ownership, indemnification, and publication rights.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Sponsor
- Institution
- Protocol Title/No.
- Principal Investigator

Clauses

- Protocol Compliance
- Subject Safety
- IP & Data Ownership
- Publication Rights
- Indemnification
- Insurance
- Confidentiality
- Term and Termination
- Governing Law

07 Privacy & Cybersecurity

Data protection laws, breach response, regulatory investigations, and compliance programs globally.

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Data Processing Agreement (DPA)

GDPR/CCPA-compliant DPA. Defines processing purposes, data categories, security measures, transfer mechanisms, and sub-processor requirements.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Controller
- Processor
- Purpose
- Data Categories
- Transfer Mechanism

Clauses

- Definitions
- Processing Purpose & Duration
- Data Subject Rights
- Security Measures
- Sub-Processors
- Cross-Border Transfers
- Breach Notification
- Audit Rights
- Governing Law

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Privacy Policy

External-facing policy for website, app, or service. Covers data collection, use, sharing, rights, and contact information.

Form Fields

- Effective Date
- Company
- Service
- DPO Contact
- Jurisdiction(s)

Clauses

- Information We Collect
- How We Use Information
- Information Sharing
- Data Subject Rights
- Data Security
- Data Retention
- Children's Privacy
- International Transfers
- Contact Information

SECTION III (CONTINUED) Document Types by Practice Area

Data Breach Response Plan

Internal incident response plan. Defines escalation, notification timelines, forensics, and regulatory reporting.

Form Fields

- Plan Date
- Plan Owner
- IR Lead
- External Counsel
- Forensics Vendor

Clauses

- Incident Classification
- Escalation
- Containment & Eradication
- Forensic Investigation
- Notification Obligations
- Regulatory Reporting
- Communications Plan
- Post-Incident Review

SECTION IV Creation Guidelines

01 Document title naming

Use full capitalization for document titles (e.g. MUTUAL NON-DISCLOSURE AGREEMENT). Keep titles concise — one or two lines at the default 18pt Cormorant Bold. Avoid abbreviations in formal document titles.

02 Field label standards

End labels with a colon and make them descriptive enough for clients to understand ("Client Name:" not just "Name:"). Group related fields. Place date fields early. Standard widths: 370 for name/address lines, 200 for dates.

03 Clause numbering and structure

Use sequential numbering (1., 2., 3.) for clauses. Each clause has a short descriptive title ending with a period ("Governing Law."). Body text in complete sentences. Capitalize defined terms consistently throughout.

04 Signature block configuration

Always include the [SEAL] notation on signature lines to comply with jurisdictions requiring sealed instruments. Two signature blocks side-by-side for bilateral agreements. For multi-party agreements, use separate signature pages. Include Print Name and Date fields below each signature line.

05 Page overflow handling

The template engine creates new pages automatically when content exceeds available space. Signature blocks always start on a fresh page if fewer than 300 points of vertical space remain. Review multi-page documents to ensure clause breaks land at logical points.

06 Quality control checklist

Before distributing: (1) verify all form fields are present and labeled, (2) confirm clause numbering is sequential, (3) check signature blocks match the parties, (4) review clause body text for typos, (5) open the PDF in Acrobat to verify AcroForm field functionality, (6) confirm the document prints with the gold rule and letterhead intact.

SECTION IV (CONTINUED) Creation Guidelines

07 Version control

Save frequently used document types as presets. Use Export as Preset to capture your configuration as JSON for sharing with colleagues. Maintain a changelog of preset modifications. For each generated document, retain the configuration JSON for reproducibility.

08 Brand consistency

All documents share the same editorial system: navy #0A1628, burgundy #6B1C2E, gold #B08D57 on cream #FAF8F5. Cormorant Garamond for serif/display, Montserrat for sans. Do not deviate from these tokens for client-facing documents without approval from Brand & Communications.

SECTION V Template Customization & Tips

01 Customizing the template presets

Presets live in `public/js/template-presets.js`. Each is a JavaScript object with: `title` (string), `fields` (array of {`label`, `name`, `width`}), `intro` (string), `witnessText` (string), `clauses` (array of {`num`, `title`, `body`}), and `signatureBlocks` (array of {`label`, `fields`}). To add a new preset, edit `template-presets.js` and add your object to `window.CarlingtonPresets` following the existing pattern.

02 Generating PDFs programmatically

`public/js/carlington-template.js` exposes `CarlingtonTemplate.generate(def)`, returning a `Uint8Array` of PDF bytes, and `CarlingtonTemplate.download(bytes, filename)` to trigger a browser download. You can call these from any page or from devtools for quick generation.

03 Adding new document types

For a type not covered by existing presets: (1) open the admin builder, (2) choose Custom from the preset dropdown, (3) enter title and filename, (4) add form fields, (5) compose clauses, (6) configure signature blocks. Click Export as Preset to save the configuration as JSON. Then add it to `template-presets.js` as a named preset.

04 Deployment

The admin builder is a static site deployed via Vercel. To ship a change: edit the relevant files under `public/` (`admin/index.html`, `js/carlington-template.js`, `js/template-presets.js`, `css/*`), then run `vercel --prod` from the project root, or push to main if your branch is connected to auto-deploy. All changes propagate to the edge within ~60 seconds.

05 Testing new templates

Always test new or modified templates: (1) generate from the admin builder, (2) open in Acrobat to verify AcroForm fields are fillable, (3) test in Apple Preview on macOS (most attorney laptops), (4) print to verify the gold rule and letterhead render correctly, (5) have a second reviewer proofread clause text.

SECTION V (CONTINUED) Template Customization & Tips

o6 Technical reference

PDF generation: pdf-lib v1.17.1 + @pdf-lib/fontkit v1.1.1, loaded via CDN in the admin shell. Template engine: public/js/carlington-template.js. Presets: public/js/template-presets.js. Admin UI: public/admin/index.html. Brand fonts: Cormorant Garamond 400/600 + Montserrat 400/500, served as .ttf from public/fonts/. Brand palette: navy #0A1628, burgundy #6B1C2E, gold #B08D57, cream #FAF8F5. For template requests or issues, contact Knowledge Management.

This playbook is an internal firm resource. For questions about the admin builder, template requests, or to report issues, contact Knowledge Management. Updated editions will be distributed as the template system evolves.

Carlington & Burling